

# What a working CRM would look like

## How I would like to see HubSpot running, and what that would be worth to the business

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### WHERE WE ARE NOW

HubSpot is in place and doing useful work. It is not yet working as a CRM. Ownership of the platform sits across several people rather than with one, the contact data has grown organically rather than by design, and there is no agreed point at which a marketing lead becomes a Business Development conversation. Everything still depends on someone having the time to do it by hand. None of that is unusual for a platform at this stage, but it does mean we are taking a fraction of the value on offer.

### WHAT A WORKING HUBSPOT LOOKS LIKE

**One owner.** A designated HubSpot manager who holds the structure, the standards and the training, rather than a platform everyone touches and nobody owns.

**Data built by design.** Every contact tagged by sector, service and interest at the point of capture, so any list we build is deliberate rather than a best guess.

**One shared record.** Marketing and BD looking at the same contact history, so nobody opens a conversation blind or repeats one a colleague has already had.

**Routine work automated.** Post event and post enquiry follow up happening on its own, reliably, every time, whether or not anyone is free that week.

**Reporting we trust.** Numbers that come out of the system rather than being assembled by hand, so campaigns can be compared honestly and repeated.

**An agreed handover.** A clear, mutually understood point at which an engaged contact becomes a BD conversation, with the full history attached.

### WHY SEGMENTATION IS THE FOUNDATION

**Everything above rests on one thing: knowing who is in the database and what they actually care about.** A single undifferentiated list means every campaign goes to everyone, which is the fastest way to train our best prospects to ignore us. Segmentation is what turns a mailing list into a commercial tool, and it is the cheapest improvement available to us, because it works with contacts we already have.

| BY SECTOR                                                                                                  | BY SERVICE                                                                                              | BY RELATIONSHIP                                                                            | BY ENGAGEMENT                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agriculture, food and drink, environment, life sciences. Lets us speak to each in language they recognise. | Which analysis or testing they already buy. Shows us who is using one service and could be using three. | Enquiry, active customer, lapsed, event attendee. A different conversation for each stage. | What they open, read and return to. Tells BD who is genuinely worth a call this month. |

**The commercial prize is cross sell.** Most of our customers buy one thing from us, often because that is the only thing they know we do. Properly segmented data is how we find the ones who should be buying two.

### THE MARKETING PROCESS, END TO END

| INTEREST                                                      | CAPTURE                                                                  | SORT                                                             | NURTURE                                                               | HANDOVER                                                        | OUTCOME                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Someone visits the site, attends an event or opens a campaign | A form or registration writes straight into HubSpot with source attached | The contact is tagged by sector, service and stage automatically | Relevant content arrives over weeks rather than one blast to everyone | At an agreed level of engagement the contact passes to BD, warm | BD records what happened, so we learn what genuinely converts |
| Marketing                                                     | The system                                                               | The system                                                       | Marketing                                                             | Marketing to BD                                                 | BD                                                            |

### WHAT THIS IS WORTH TO THE BUSINESS

- ✓ **BD time spent on warm conversations.** Leads arrive already engaged and already informed, with the history attached.
- ✓ **Fewer enquiries quietly lost.** Nothing sits in an inbox or a spreadsheet waiting for someone to notice it.
- ✓ **Campaigns that can be repeated.** Consistent measurement means we can tell what worked and do it again.
- ✓ **Marketing spend traced to pipeline.** A clear line from activity through to opportunity, in numbers rather than anecdote.
- ✓ **A database that is an asset.** Clean, consented, well structured data is worth something. A messy one is a liability.
- ✓ **Knowledge that outlasts people.** Relationships live in the system rather than in one person's head or inbox.

**The point is not the software.** HubSpot can already do all of this. The difference between a contact list and a CRM is ownership, structure and an agreed process between Marketing and Business Development. That is the version I would like us to build towards.